



DeKalb Community Unit
School District 428

ENGLISH APPLICATION AND INSTRUCTIONS

2025/2026 Fee Waiver Application

All registered children in the DeKalb CUSD #428 will receive one free breakfast and one free lunch due to the community eligibility provision (CEP) status for the 2025/2026 school year. Milk only purchases are not free and accounts will be charged \$0.50 per milk. If your child brings meals from home, please include a drink to avoid being charged. A la Carte items are not free or reduced and will be charged at full price.

The attached application is only to determine benefits for Registration/Student Fees for the 2025/2026 school year. If you receive SNAP or TANF benefits, please include the case number. **Do not use your Medicaid case number. All portions of the application must be completed to successfully in order to process.**

Return the completed fee waiver application to Dekalb School District Education Center at 901 S. 4th Street or to the main office at your student's school.

Frequently Asked Questions:

1. DO I NEED TO FILL OUT AN APPLICATION FOR EACH CHILD? No. Complete the application to apply for free or reduced fees. Use one Household Eligibility Application for all students in your household per district. We cannot approve an application that is not complete, so be sure to fill out all required information. Return the completed application to the school.
2. WHO CAN GET FREE FEE WAIVERS? All children in households receiving benefits from Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) and/or are foster children that are under the legal responsibility of a foster care agency or court are eligible for free fees regardless of your income. Also, your children can get free waivers if your households' gross income is within the free limits on the Federal Income Eligibility Guidelines. Children who meet the definition of homeless, runaway, or migrant also qualify. If you have not been told your children will get free waivers, please contact the district office to see if your child(ren) qualifies.
3. WHO CAN GET REDUCED WAIVERS? Your children can qualify for reduced fees if your household income is within the reduced-price limits on the Federal Eligibility chart on the back of the application.
4. A MEMBER OF MY HOUSEHOLD RECEIVED SNAP OR TANF BENEFITS. THE SCHOOL SENT A LETTER STATING THAT MY CHILD IS AUTOMATICALLY APPROVED FOR FREE MEALS BASED ON DIRECT CERTIFICATION. DO I NEED TO DO ANYTHING MORE TO ENSURE THAT MY CHILD RECIEVES A FREE WAIVER? No. You do not need to do anything more to receive a free waiver for your child. If you have students not listed on the letter, contact the school immediately. If you do not wish to receive the free waiver, you should follow the steps outlined in the letter from the district to notify school personnel.
5. HOW DO I KNOW IF MY CHILDREN QUALIFY AS HOMELESS, MIGRANT, OR RUNAWAY? Does your family relocate on a seasonal basis? Are there any children living with you who have chosen to leave their prior family or household? If you believe children in your household meet these descriptions and have not been told your children will receive free waivers, contact the district office.
6. MY CHILD'S APPLICATION WAS APPROVED LAST YEAR; DO I NEED TO FILL OUT ANOTHER ONE? Yes, your child's application is only good for that school year and 30 days into the next school year. You must send in a new application.
7. I GET WIC, CAN MY CHILDREN GET FREE WAIVER? Children in households participating in WIC may be eligible for free or reduced waivers. Please fill out the enclosed application.
8. WILL THE INFORMATION I GIVE BE CHECKED? Yes, we may ask you to send written proof.
9. IF I DON'T QUALIFY NOW, MAY I APPLY LATER? Yes, you may apply at any time during the school year. For example, children with a parent or guardian who become unemployed may become eligible for free or reduced fees if the household income drops below the income limit.
10. WHAT IF I DISAGREE WITH THE DISTRICT'S DECISION ABOUT MY APPLICATION? You should talk with the district officials. You may ask for a hearing by calling or writing.
11. MAY I APPLY IF SOMEONE IN MY HOUSEHOLD IS NOT A U.S. CITIZEN? Yes. You or your child(ren) do not have to be U.S. citizen to qualify for free or reduced fees.
12. WHO SHOULD I INCLUDE AS MEMBERS OF MY HOUSEHOLD? You must include all people living in your household, related or not, who share income and expenses. You must include yourself and all children living with you.
13. WHAT IF MY INCOME IS NOT ALWAYS THE SAME? List the amount that you normally receive. For example, if you normally make \$1000 each month, but you missed some work last month and only made \$900, put down that you made \$1000 per month. If you normally get overtime, include it, but do not include it if you only work overtime sometimes. If you have lost a job or had your hours or wages reduced, use your current income.
14. WHAT IF SOME HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS HAVE NO INCOME TO REPORT? Please write 0 in the field. If any fields are left blank, those will also be counted as zeros.
15. WE ARE IN THE MILITARY. DO WE REPORT OUR INCOME DIFFERENTLY? Your basic pay and cash bonuses must be reported as income. If you get any cash value allowances for off-base housing, food or clothing, it must also be included as income. However, if your housing is part of the Military Housing Privatization Initiative, you do not include your housing allowance as income. An additional combat pay resulting from deployment is also excluded from income.
16. MY FAMILY NEEDS MORE HELP. ARE THERE OTHER PROGRAMS WE MIGHT APPLY FOR? To find out how to apply for SNAP, TANF or other assistance, contact your local Department of Human Services Office or call 800-843-6154(voice) or 800-447-6404 (TTY).

INSTRUCTIONS FOR APPLYING – COMPLETE ONE APPLICATION PER HOUSEHOLD PER SCHOOL DISTRICT

IF YOUR HOUSEHOLD RECEIVES SNAP OR TANF BENEFITS, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND RETURN THE COMPLETED FORM TO YOUR SCHOOL:

Part 1: List all household members, school and grade level of each student, and a SNAP or TANF case number for any household member including adults receiving such benefits. (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary.)

Parts 2 & 3: Skip these parts.

Part 4: Sign the form. The last four digits of a Social Security Number are not necessary.

Parts 5 & 6: If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

IF NO ONE IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD GETS SNAP OR TANF BENEFITS AND IF ANY CHILD IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD IS HOMELESS, A MIGRANT OR RUNAWAY OR HEAD START/EVEN START, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND RETURN THE COMPLETED FORM TO YOUR SCHOOL:

Part 1: List all household members; provide the school and grade level of each student in the household. (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary.)

Part 2: If any child you are applying for is homeless, migrant, or a runaway, check the appropriate box and call your school.

Part 3: Complete only if a child in your household isn't eligible under Part 2. See instructions for All Other Households.

Part 4: Adult household member must sign the form. If you completed Part 3 of the application, you must include the last four digits of the adult's Social Security Number (or mark the box if you do not have one).

Parts 5 & 6: If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

IF YOU ARE APPLYING FOR A FOSTER CHILD, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND RETURN THE COMPLETED FORM TO YOUR SCHOOL:

If all children in the household are foster children that are the legal responsibility of a foster care agency or court:

Part 1: List all foster children and the name of each child's school. Check the "Foster Child" box for each foster child.

Parts 2 & 3: Skip these parts.

Part 4: Sign the form. The last four digits of a Social Security number are not necessary.

Parts 5 & 6: If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

If some (but not all) of the children in the household are foster children that are the legal responsibility of a foster care agency or court:

Part 1: List all household members and the name of each child's school. Check the "Foster Child" box for each foster child. **Part 2:** If any child you are applying for is homeless, migrant, or a runaway, check the appropriate box and call your school. **Part 3:** Follow these instructions to report total household income from this month or last month.

- **Box 1 – Name:** List all household members with income.
- **Box 2 – Gross Income and How Often it Was Received:** For each household member, list each type of income received for the month. You must tell us how often the money is received – weekly, every other week, twice a month, or monthly. For earnings, be sure to list the gross income, not the take-home pay. Gross income is the amount earned before taxes and other deductions. You should be able to find it on your pay stub or your boss can tell you. For other income, list the amount each person received for the month from welfare, child support, alimony, pensions, retirement, Social Security, Supplemental Security Income (SSI), Veteran's benefits (VA benefits), and disability benefits. Under All Other Income, list any payment received for Worker's Compensation, unemployment or strike benefits, regular contributions from people who do not live in your household, and any other income. Do not include income from SNAP, FDIPIR, WIC, Federal education benefits and foster payments received by the household from the placing agency. For ONLY the self-employed, under Earnings from Work, report income after expenses. This is for your business, farm, or rental property. If you are in the Military Privatized Housing Initiative or receive combat pay, do not include these allowances as income.

Part 4: Adult household member must sign the form and list the last four digits of their Social Security Number (or mark the box if you do not have one).

Parts 5 & 6: If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

ALL OTHER HOUSEHOLDS INCLUDING MEDICAID AND WIC HOUSEHOLDS, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS:

Part 1: List all household members; provide the school and grade level of each student in the household. (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary.)

Part 2: If any child you are applying for is homeless, migrant, or a runaway, check the appropriate box and call your school.

Part 3: Follow these instructions to report total household income from this month or last month.

- **Box 1 – Name:** List all household members with income.
- **Box 2 – Gross Income and How Often it Was Received:** For each household member, list each type of income received for the month. You must tell us how often the money is received – weekly, every other week, twice a month, or monthly. For earnings, be sure to list the gross income, not the take-home pay. Gross income is the amount earned before taxes and other deductions. You should be able to find it on your pay stub or your boss can tell you. For other income, list the amount each person received for the month from welfare, child support, alimony, pensions, retirement, Social Security, Supplemental Security Income (SSI), Veteran's benefits (VA benefits), and disability benefits. Under All Other Income, list any payment received for Worker's Compensation, unemployment or strike benefits, regular contributions from people who do not live in your household, and any other income. Do not include income from SNAP, FDIPIR, WIC, Federal education benefits and foster payments received by the household from the placing agency. For ONLY the self-employed, under Earnings from Work, report income after expenses. This is for your business, farm, or rental property. If you are in the Military Privatized Housing Initiative or receive combat pay, do not include these allowances as income.

Part 4: Adult household member must sign the form and list the last four digits of their Social Security Number (or mark the box if you do not have one).

Parts 5 & 6: If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

Privacy Act Statement: **This explains how we will use the information you give us.** The Richard B. Russell National School Lunch Act requires the information on this application. You do not have to give the information, but if you do not, we cannot approve your child for free or reduced-price meals. You must include the last four digits of the social security number of the adult household member who signs the application. The last four digits of the social security number is not required when you apply on behalf of a foster child or you list a Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) Program, or Food Distribution Program on Indian Reservations (FDPIR) case number or other FDIPIR identifier for your child or when you indicate that the adult household member signing the application does not have a social security number. We will use your information to determine if your child is eligible for free or reduced-price meals and for administration and enforcement of the lunch and breakfast programs. We may share your eligibility information with education, health, and nutrition programs to help them deliver program benefits to your household. Inspectors and law enforcement may also use your information to make sure that program rules are met.

In accordance with the federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) civil rights regulations and policies, this institution is prohibited from discriminating on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex (including gender identity and sexual orientation), disability, age, or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity. Program information may be made available in languages other than English. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means of communication to obtain program information (e.g., Braille, large print, audiotype, American Sign Language), should contact the responsible state or local agency that administers the program or USDA's TARGET Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and TTY) or contact USDA through the Federal Relay Service at (800) 877-8339. To file a program discrimination complaint, a Complainant should complete a Form AD-3027, USDA Program Discrimination Complaint Form which can be obtained online at <https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/USDA-OASCR%20P-Complaint-Form-0508-0002-508-11-28-17Fax2Mail.pdf>, from any USDA office, by calling (866) 632-9992, or by writing a letter addressed to USDA. The letter must contain the complainant's name, address, telephone number, and a written description of the alleged discriminatory action in sufficient detail to inform the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights (ASCR) about the nature and date of an alleged civil rights violation. The completed AD-3027 form or letter must be submitted to USDA by: 1) mail: U.S. Department of Agriculture, Office of the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington D.C. 20250-9410; or 2) fax: (833) 256-1665 or (202) 690-7442; or 3) email: program.intake@usda.gov.

Complete one application per household, per school district. Instructions on the back of this form.

1. All Household Members (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary)

NAMES OF ALL HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS (Include school name and grade if household member is a student.)			SNAP OR TANF CASE NUMBER ONLY Skip to part 4 if you list a SNAP or TANF case number. At least one SNAP/TANF must be provided below. If you receive Medicaid and were not directly certified for free meals, you MUST apply based on household size and income.	Check if Foster Child*
First, Middle Initial, Last	School Name	Grade		
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

* A foster child is the legal responsibility of a welfare agency or court.

2. Homeless, Migrant, Runaway, or Head Start (Categorically Eligible)

☐ Homeless

☐ Migrant

☐ Runaway

☐ Head Start

Signature of your school Homeless Liaison, Migrant Coordinator, or Head Start Director

Date

3. Total Household Gross Income (before deductions). You must tell us how much and how often.

A. NAMES (LIST ALL HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS WITH INCOME)	GROSS INCOME AND HOW OFTEN IT WAS RECEIVED (Example: \$100/month; \$100/twice a month; \$100/every other week; \$100/week)							
	B. Earnings from Work (Before Deductions)		C. Welfare, Child Support, Alimony		D. Pensions, Retirement, Social Security		E. All Other Income (Worker's Comp., SSI, Unemployment, etc.)	
	Amount	How often?	Amount	How often?	Amount	How often?	Amount	How often?
i.	\$		\$		\$		\$	
ii.	\$		\$		\$		\$	
iii.	\$		\$		\$		\$	
iv.	\$		\$		\$		\$	
v.	\$		\$		\$		\$	

4. Signature and Social Security Number (Adult Must Sign)

An adult household member must sign the application. If Part 3 is completed, the adult signing the form must also list the last four digits of his or her social Security number or mark the box if they do not have social security number.

LAST FOUR
OF SOCIAL
SECURITY
NUMBER

OR ☐ I do not have a social security number

I certify (promise) all information on this application is true and all income is reported. I understand the school will get Federal funds based on the information I give. I understand school officials may verify (check) the information. I understand if I purposely give false information, my children may lose meal benefits and I may be prosecuted.

Date

Printed Name of Adult Household Member

Signature of Adult Household Member

5. Contact Information (optional)

Work Telephone Number (Include Area Code)

Home Telephone Number (Include Area Code)

Home Address (Number, Street, City, State, ZIP Code)

6. Children's Ethnic and Racial Identities (optional)

Mark one ethnic identity:

☐ Hispanic/Latino

☐ Not Hispanic/Latino

Mark one or more racial identities:

☐ Asian

☐ Black or African American

☐ White

☐ American Indian or Alaska Native

☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander

- THIS SECTION IS FOR SCHOOL USE ONLY -

INITIAL DETERMINATION

TOTAL INCOME

\$

Per:

☐ Week

☐ Every 2 Weeks

☐ Twice a Month

☐ Month

☐ Year

NUMBER IN HOUSEHOLD:

CHANGE IN STATUS:

DATE

LEAS must annualize income ONLY when multiple incomes at varying frequencies are reported.

Annual Income Conversion:

Weekly

\$ x 52 = \$

Every 2 Weeks

\$ x 26 = \$

Twice a Month

\$ x 24 = \$

Once a month

\$ x 12 = \$

☐ Free based on:

☐ Homeless

☐ Migrant

☐ Runaway

☐ Head Start

☐ SNAP or TANF

☐ Foster Child

☐ Household's Income

☐ Reduced based on:

☐ Household's Income

☐ Denied - Reason

☐ Income too high

☐ Incomplete Application

☐ Non-Qualifying SNAP/TANF

Signature of Determining Official

Date:

FISCAL YEAR 2025/2026 INCOME ELIGIBILITY GUIDELINES

The United States Department of Agriculture has issued the following guidelines for the period July 1, 2025 through June 30, 2026.

Income Eligibility Guidelines Effective July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2026 Reduced Price 185% Federal Poverty Guideline					
Household Size	Annual	Monthly	Twice Per Month	Every Two Weeks	Weekly
1	28,953	2,413	1,207	1,114	557
2	39,128	3,261	1,631	1,505	753
3	49,303	4,109	2,055	1,897	949
4	59,478	4,957	2,479	2,288	1,144
5	69,653	5,805	2,903	2,679	1,340
6	79,828	6,653	3,327	3,071	1,536
7	90,003	7,501	3,751	3,462	1,731
8	100,178	8,349	4,175	3,853	1,927
For each additional family member, add:	10,175	848	424	392	196

In accordance with federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) civil rights regulation and policies, this institution is prohibited from discriminating on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex (including gender identity and sexual orientation), disability, age or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity.

Program information may be made available in languages other than English. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means of communication to obtain program information (e.g. Braille, large print, audiotope, American Sign Language), should contact the responsible state or local agency that administers the program or USDA's TARGET Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and TTY) or contact USDA through the Federal Relay Service at 800-877-8339.

To file a program discrimination complaint, a Complaint should complete a Form AD-3027, USDA Program Discrimination Complaint Form which can be obtained online at: <https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/USDA-OASCR%20P-Complaint-Form-0508-0002-508-11-28-17Fax2Mail.pdf>, from any USDA office, by calling (866) 632-9992, or by writing a letter addressed to USDA. The letter must contain the complaints name, address, telephone number, and a written description of the alleged discriminatory action in sufficient detail to inform the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights (ASCR) about the nature and date of an alleged civil rights violation. The completed AD_3027 form or letter must be submitted to the USDA by:

1. Mail
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Office of the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights
1400 Independence Avenue, SW
Washington, D.C. 20250-9410

2. Fax:
(833) 256-1665 or (202) 690-7442

3. Email:
Program.intake@usda.gov